



Digital Literacy Project Report

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- **Introduction**

This project was completed as part of my role as a **Student Digital Ambassador**. The primary objective is to build a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio that demonstrates the ability to navigate the digital world safely, professionally, and effectively. Throughout this project, I completed five distinct tasks ranging from visual communication and professional networking to coding practice and cybercrime awareness. This report documents my work across these modules, providing reflections on the tools used and the digital skills I have developed to assist my peers in their academic and professional journeys.

Task 1 Write-up: Digital Literacy Infographic

For this task, I created a visual resource designed to help my batchmates at VIT Bhopal understand the core pillars of digital literacy. I used **Canva** to design the infographic because of its user-friendly drag-and-drop interface and wide variety of professional educational templates. My design specifically covers three essential areas: **a clear definition of what digital literacy is, a list of useful digital tools for modern students, and a guide to safe internet practices.**

The visual layout was designed to be clean and easy to read at a glance, utilizing high-quality icons and a consistent color scheme to represent different digital concepts. One thing I found particularly interesting was the challenge of condensing complex information regarding internet safety and data privacy into a few concise bullet points. I realized that for an infographic to be effective as an ambassadorial tool, it must balance deep information with visual impact to ensure the message is not lost. This process improved my ability to synthesize information for a specific audience

Task 2 Write-up: Student Digital Portfolio

Building a professional digital presence is no longer optional in the engineering field; it is a baseline expectation for employers and the academic community. For this task, I established and updated my foundational profiles on **GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle**. On GitHub, I created a profile README that serves as a digital introduction, detailing my current branch in Bioengineering and Biotechnology, my year of study, and my specific learning goals. On LinkedIn, I focused on accuracy by updating my education section to reflect my status at VIT Bhopal University.

I chose these specific platforms because **LinkedIn** is the industry standard for professional networking and internship hunting, while **GitHub** acts as a live repository for my technical skills and coding projects. Over the next four years, I plan to use these profiles as a chronological record of my academic growth. I intend to document my progress in Python programming and use ResearchGate or LinkedIn to connect with global peers for collaborative bio-tech research projects.

Task 3 Write-up: Coding & Collaboration

To build technical and collaborative proficiency, I engaged with both **coding practice platforms and cloud-based workspace tools**. For the coding portion, I utilized **HackerRank** and successfully completed the **'Python Introduction' challenge**. This exercise was highly beneficial as it allowed me to practice basic logic, input/output handling, and Python syntax within a timed, competitive environment.

In addition to coding, I developed a **Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms**. I designed five targeted questions to test my batchmates' understanding of online safety, ensuring the form included both multiple-choice and short-answer formats. I then linked this form to a Google Sheet to automate response tracking and data analysis. These tools are invaluable for my academic career, as they allow me to conduct efficient surveys for group projects and maintain a structured schedule for coding practice. Developing these skills now ensures I am prepared for the collaborative and technical demands of the biotechnology industry

Task 4 Write-up: Email Etiquette

In this module, I practiced professional communication by drafting two distinct emails: **one requesting a deadline extension from a professor** and another **expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity**. Both drafts focused on maintaining a formal tone, clear subject lines, and appropriate professional sign-offs to ensure clarity and respect.

Reflecting on digital communication, I researched a scenario where a student sent an overly casual email to a recruiter and was immediately disqualified from the selection process. This highlighted the critical importance of "**Digital Etiquette**," as the professional world often judges competence based on written correspondence. The situation could have been easily avoided if the sender had used a formal greeting and thoroughly proofread the message for tone. I have now developed a checklist of 5 Do's and 5 Don'ts to guide my future interactions as a Digital Ambassador.

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness

While researching **UPI and online payment fraud** for my case study, I was most surprised by how sophisticated social engineering has become. Specifically, learning how scammers use "Collect Requests" to trick users into entering their PINs—a step only required for sending money—was a major eye-opener. I previously assumed that digital literacy was simply about knowing how to operate an app, but I now realize it is actually about understanding the underlying logic of how digital money moves.

As a result of this research, one habit I will personally change is **never entering my UPI PIN while on a phone call with a stranger**, regardless of how professional or urgent they sound. I have also saved the **1930 Helpline** and the National Cyber Crime Portal details in my contacts to ensure I can act quickly if a fraudulent transaction occurs

- **Conclusion**

Completing this Digital Literacy project has provided me with a **foundational set of skills necessary for a successful engineering student**. From creating professional identities on GitHub and LinkedIn to understanding the nuances of cyber safety, I now feel better equipped to serve as a Digital Ambassador. This project has taught me that **being digitally literate is not just about using tools, but about using them responsibly, professionally, and safely to enhance both my own education and the digital well-being of my peers**.

- **References:**

- Canva <https://canva.com>
- GitHub <https://github.com>
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal <https://cybercrime.gov.in>
- HackerRank
- LinkedIn